

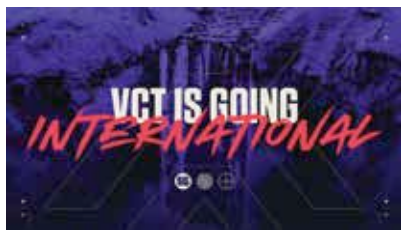


ASIA'S GROWING ROLE IN THE VALORANT SCENE WORLDWIDE

How long until we see an Indian team on the international stage?

By Paarth "Cruciator" Pareek | feedback@skoar.in

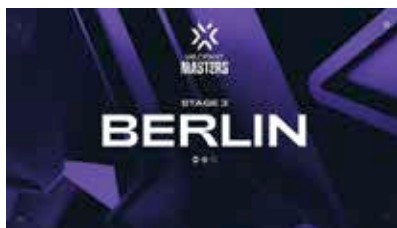
As Masters Reykjavik 2022 comes to an end, we thought we'd bring to your notice a few things that are changing around the world. In case you weren't watching Masters this time around because those gosh darn Americans always win anyway, and they did so this time as well. But, here's what changed. Out of the top 4 teams in the semis, 2 were from Asia, which has never happened before. Does this mean we're on the rise? Will we see an Indian team on the international stage next time around? Why don't you read on and we'll try to answer all your questions in the best way possible.



THE CONSISTENT LOWS OVER THE YEARS.

One of the most consistent teams

since the beginning has been Paper Rex from Singapore. They defeated the Indian Global eSports in the APAC last chance qualifiers the first time around for a spot at Masters Berlin 2021 but went on to get a not-so-strong finish as they finished a poor 13th. The future of Asian teams in Valorant seemed pretty dull as none of the Asian teams could actually crack a position higher than 7th by Vision Strikers from Korea.



As time moved on, we saw Masters : Berlin come along where the APAC region was represented by Paper Rex who finished a sad 13th. All Asian teams returned from Berlin with disappointment on their faces and a fire to do better in their hearts to no avail though. Along came the showcase event of Valorant Champions, the biggest tournament that Riot hosts

towards the end of the year in their Valorant Champions Tour. This time around as well, the highest position that an Asian team received was 7th yet again by X10 CRIT, a Thai team that had recently merged with CRIT eSports from Brunei. Other teams ended in the last few positions of the table which didn't look promising for the future of said teams on the international level.

THE GROWTH

Coming over to the growth that the Asian teams have shown in the past few months is commendable. Paper Rex has once again become what it once used to be, Full Sense has been on the rise, DRX rose from the ashes, and Velocity Gaming, along with Global eSports qualified for the VCT APAC qualifiers for Masters Reykjavik.

Multiple new teams were formed and tons of player transfers took place in the span of the previous year since the last qualifiers. Here's a list of things that mattered to reach the level we are currently at.

The Fall of the Titans : The earliest winners of the various LAN events of the VCT were all teams from North